

Museum
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1957

A COPTIC APOCRYPHON OF SAINT STEPHEN THE ARCHDEACON

The text of this Apocryphon is preserved in MS. M577 of the Pierpont Morgan Collection, which is dated on fol. 49^v A.M. 611 (= A.D. 894-895)¹. It runs from fol. 2^r to fol. 12^r (pp. 3-23).

Our text is in the Ša'idic dialect, though there are a few words which have Fayyūmic forms. Orthographical errors are few, and these have been recorded in the foot-notes.

The Coptic text contains :

- 1) A short exhortation by Saint Stephen.
- 2) His marriage and the birth of a daughter.
- 3) His retirement to a mountain.
- 4) The appearance of the Holy Virgin Mary to him, commanding him to go and see his daughter and to encourage her to accept her death willingly.
- 5) The conversion of three robbers by him.
- 6) His election as one of the Seven Deacons and Stewards.

Mgr Jacob Muyser has drawn my attention to a fragment of this text edited without translation or commentary by I. GUMI, *Frammenti copti*, 2 fasc. (Roma, 1887), pp. 47-52. This fragment corresponds to the text on fol. 9^r, l. 24a to fol. 10^v, l. 17a of our MS (§ 27-34). I thank my friend Dr. Burmester for his kind help.

ΝΑΙΝΕ ΝΕΡΟΛΗΤΙΑ ΜΠΖΑΓΙΟΣ ΜΜΑΡΤΥΡΟΣ ΜΠΕΧ̄Σ ΣΤΕΦΑ-
ΝΟΣ ΠΑΡΧΗΔΙΑΚΟΝΟΣ ΛΥΩ ΠΩΟΡΠ ΜΜΑΡΤΥΡΟΣ. ΖΝΟΥΕΙΡΗΝΗ
ΝΤΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ. ΖΑΜΗΝ.

1. ΣΩΤΗ ΕΡΟΙ Ω ΝΕΜΑΙΧΙΣΩ ΧΙΣΜΗ ΕΝΑΦΑΧΕ ΝΕΜΑΙΟΓΟΣ

These are the *affairs* of the *holy martyr* of Christ Stephen (Stephanos), *archdeacon* and *first martyr*, in the *peace* of God. Amen.

1. Hear me, O lovers of knowledge, listen to my words, lovers of the

¹ Cf. Arn. VAN LANTSCHOOT, *Recueil des Colophons de Manuscrits chrétiens d'Égypte*, t. I (Louvain 1929), No XXI, pp. 39-40, who gives the text of the colophon of this MS. in full with the translation in French.

ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ· ΝΤΕΤΝΕΙΜΕ ΧΕΠΡΩΜΕ ΕΤΝΑΨΕΩΖΗΤ ΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ
ΜΕΩΚΑΑΩ ΝΩΩΩ ΦΑΒΟΛ ΑΛΛΑ ΦΑΩΒΕΠΗ ΝΩΤΑΝΩΩΩ ΝΩΧΑΩΤΩ
ΩΜΠΕΩΩΩ.

2. ΑΝΟΚΠΕ ΣΤΕΦΑΝΟΣ ΠΙΕΛΑΧΙΣΤΟΣ ΟΥΑ ΕΒΟΛ ΩΜΠΩΩΩ
ΝΑΙΑΚΟΝΟΣ ΝΗ ΕΒΟΛ ΩΝΝΙΚΟΝΟΜΟΣ ΝΑΪ ΝΤΑΥΚΑ-ΘΙΣΤΑ ΜΜΟΩΩ
ΝΩΙΝΩΝΕΙΟΤΕ ΝΑΠΟΩΤΟΛΟΣ· ΑΥΤΑΩΩΝ ΕΡΑΤΗ ΕΧΝΝΕΧΡΙΑ
ΕΤΤΕΝΩΕΠΡΩΩΩΩ ΝΝΕΧΗΡΑ ΜΝΝΟΡΦΑΝΟΣ ΜΝΟΥΩΝ ΝΙΜ ΕΤ-
ΦΑΑΤ· ΕΝΧΩΡΗΓΕΙ ΝΑΥ ΜΠΕΤΟΥΡΧΡΙΑ ΜΜΩΩ.

3. ΑΩΩΩΠΕ ΔΕ ΜΜΟΙ ΜΠΕΩΩΩΕΩΩ ΕΙΟ ΝΚΟΥΙ ΑΝΑΕΙΟΤΕ ΧΙ
ΝΑΙ ΝΟΥΩΩΩΜΕ ΚΑΤΑΠΓΑΜΟΣ ΧΕΝΝΑΠΩΤ ΩΝΤΕΩΩΗ ΝΝΙΠΑΡΑ-
ΝΟΜΟΣ. ΑΩΧΠΟ ΝΑΙ ΝΟΥΩΩΗΡΕ ΜΜΟΝΟΓΕΝΗΣ.

4. ΕΝΕΩΥΝΤΑΙ ΝΩΑΩ ΝΩΥΠΑΡΧΟΝΤΑ ΑΠΩΤ ΕΧΝΟΥΤΟΩΩ
ΑΙΤΑΜΙΟ ΝΑΙ ΝΟΥΩΚΥΝΗ ΩΜΠΜΑ ΕΤΜΜΑΥ ΧΕΚΑΣ ΝΝΑΕΪ ΡΩ
ΕΠΕΩΩΤ ΕΤΠΟΛΙΩ ΕΝΑΥ ΕΡΩΜΕ ΟΥΔΕ ΩΩΩΜΕ. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΑΙ-
ΕΡΑΝΑΩ ΜΠΧΟΕΙΩ ΩΝΝΑ-ΘΥΩΙΑ ΕΨΕΙΡΕ ΜΜΟΩΩ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΜΠΠΕΤ-
ΝΑΝΟΥΩΩ ΝΙΜ. ΕΙΧΩ ΔΕ ΝΝΑΙ ΕΪΤΑΙΟ ΜΜΟΙ ΜΜΙΝ ΜΜΟΙ.

5. ΛΟΙΠΟΝ ΡΩΜΕ ΝΙΜ ΕΤΝΑΩΟΥΩΟΥ ΜΜΩΩ ΜΜΙΝ ΜΜΩΩ
ΩΜΠΠΕΤΝΑΝΟΥΩΩ ΕΤΕΩΕΙΡΕ ΜΜΩΩ ΜΕΩΧΙΑΑΑΥ ΝΩΕΚΗ ΩΑΤΗ-
ΠΝΟΥΤΕ. ΜΑΛΛΩΝ ΔΕ ΦΑΩΩΩΧΩ ΩΜΠΕΩΚΕΤΑΙΟ ΩΝΤΠΟΛΙΩ
ΜΠΕΩΩ ΕΤΩΕΤΗΝΤΧΑΩΩΩΩ ΝΤΑΩΧΠΩΩ ΝΑΩ.

word of God, that ye may know that the man who shall give his heart to God, He is not ever wont to forsake him, *but* He is wont to hasten to give him life and to exalt him in glory.

2. I am Stephen (Stephanos) the *least*, one of the seven *deacons*, those of the *stewards* whom our fathers the *Apostles* appointed. They put us in charge of what was *needed* that we might have care of the *widows* and the *orphans* and of everyone who was in want, *providing* for them in their *need*.

3. *And* it happened to me, at that time, I being young, (that) my parents took for me a woman *according to* (the law of) *marriage*, so that I might not walk in the way of the *lawless*. She bore to me an *only* child.

4. I had many *possessions*; I fled upon a mountain; I made for myself a *tent* there in order that I might not come down again to the *city* to see (either) a man *or* a woman. *And* I pleased the Lord with my *sacrifices* which I made, and (with) all (my) good (works); *but* in saying these (things), I honour myself.

5. *For the rest*, every man who shall boast of the good (work) which he doeth, is not wont to receive any wage from God, *but rather* he is wont to be humbled with regard to his honour in the *city* of Christ on account of the pride which he hath assumed to himself.

6. ΚΑΙΓΑΡ ΟΥΝΟΥΑΤΑ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΕΥΩΟΠ ΩΝΩΕΝΝΟΩ ΝΝΩΕ
ΕΥΕΙΡΕ ΜΜΟΩΩ ΦΑΡΟΥΩΕ ΜΜΗΝΕ ΕΥΧΙΜΗΩΕ ΜΗΩΕ ΕΥΧΙ
ΝΝΕΩΩΗΚΕ ΝΩΩΩ ΕΥΩΙΟΥΕ ΕΝΟΡΦΑΝΟΣ ΕΥ-ΘΜΚΟ ΝΤΕΧΗΡΑ
ΕΥΩΩΩΕ ΝΝΕΡΓΑΤΗΩ ΜΠΕΥΩΕΚΗ ΕΥΠΟΡΝΕΥΕ ΜΝΝΕΩΩΩΜΕ
ΕΤΕΝΝΩΟΥ ΑΝΝΕ ΑΥΩ ΕΥΕΙΡΕ ΝΩΕΝΚΕΜΗΩΩΕ ΝΝΩΕ ΜΝΩΕΝ-
ΚΕΜΗΩΩΕ ΝΑΝΟΜΙΑ.

7. ΕΥΩΑΝΠΩΩ ΔΕ ΕΥΩΩΩΩ ΝΩΕΕΡΠΜΕΕΥΕ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΦΑΥ-
ΧΟΩΩ ΧΕΝΑΡΕΝΤΩΟΥΝ ΜΠΩΩΩ ΝΤΕΝΨ ΝΟΥΑΓΑΠΗ ΩΑΠΕΝΟΥ-
ΧΑΪ ΜΝΠΟΥΧΑΙ ΜΠΕΝΗΗ ΤΗΡΩ ΦΑΥΤΩΟΥΝ ΝΩΕΤΑΩΕΩΕΩ
ΜΠΩΩΩ ΕΤΟΥΝΑΑΑΩ ΝΩΕΤΑΡΑΩΩΕ ΜΠΚΩΩΩΩ ΕΡΕΝΕΥΩΩΩΑ
ΠΗΤ ΕΠΩΑ ΜΠΠΑΙ ΕΥΚΥΡΙΩΕ ΜΠΩΩΩ ΕΤΟΥΕΙΡΕ ΜΜΩΩ.

8. ΝΑΪΩΕ ΝΤΕΙΜΙΝΕ ΑΠΕΝΩΩΤΗΡ ΟΥΩ ΕΩΩΩ ΜΜΩΩ ΝΑΥ
ΩΜΠΕΥΑΓΓΕΛΙΩΝ ΧΕΩΑΜΗΝ ΨΩ ΜΜΩΩ ΝΗΤΗ ΧΕΑΥΟΥΩ ΕΥΧΙ
ΜΠΕΥΩΕΚΗ. ΝΩΕΝΑΕΩΩΧΙ ΑΝ ΜΠΤΑΙΟ ΝΝΙΡΩΜΕ ΝΩΕΧΙ ΜΠΑ-
ΠΝΟΥΤΕ. ΝΑΙ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΝΤΑΙΧΟΩΩ ΧΕΑΙΩΜΩΕ ΜΠΧΟΕΙΩ ΕΙΕΙΡΕ
ΝΩΕΝΠΟΛΥΤΙΑ ΕΥΩΩΗ ΕΜΝΡΩΜΕ ΩΟΟΥΝ ΜΜΟΩΩ ΕΙΕΜΗΤΕΙ
ΠΧΟΕΙΩ ΜΑΥΑΑΩ.

9. ΑΩΩΩΠΕ ΔΕ ΝΟΥΩΩΩΩ ΑΙΕΡΠΩΩ ΜΠΡΟ ΜΠΜΑΝΩΩΠΕ
ΑΩΩΩΩΩ ΝΟΥΚΟΥΙ ΑΩΩΩΩ ΑΙΝΑΥ ΕΥΚΛΟΩΕ ΝΟΥΩΕΙΝ ΕΡΕ-

6. *For also* there are some men abiding in great sins, committing them until evening every day, taking usury, wronging the poor, striking the *orphans*, afflicting the *widow*, robbing the labourers of their wage, *fornicating* with women who are not theirs, and committing a multitude of other *iniquities*.

7. *And* if they reach a day (on which) they remember God, they are wont to say: «Let us arise to-day, and give *charity* for our salvation and for the salvation of all our house». They are wont to arise and proclaim the work which they will do, to *stir* the *world*, while their servants go hither and thither, *heralding* the work which they do.

8. To these, moreover, of this kind, Our *Saviour* declared, saying to them in the *Gospel*: «Amen, I say unto you, they have already received their reward»¹. They will not be able to receive the honour of men² and to receive that of God. All these (things) I said, because I served the Lord, doing hidden *works* which no man knows *save* the Lord alone.

9. *And* it happened one day, that I was outside the door of (my)³ dwell-
ing-place, (and) I sat for a little. I looked (and) I saw a shining cloud,

¹ *Matth.*, vi, 2.

² *Lit.* 'these men'.

³ *Lit.* 'the'.

MARIA TMAAY MΠXOEIC ZMOOC EXWC. ACMOYTE EPOI ECXW MMOC XECTAFANOC ΠAPXHAIAKONOC TPHNH NAK. EITA ΠEXAC NAI XETFOYN NΓIWT ZNOYEPHNH ZNOYBETH ΦATEKΦEPE MMONOΓENHC. MMON EIC CAWQ NZOY ECENKOTK ECΦONE EPETECMAAY MOKZ NZHT ECOYΦΦ EEIME XEEKΦOON NTΩN. MΠOYEME EΠTOΠOC ETEKENZHTQ NCETNNOOY NCOK MΠATEKOYE MMOY NΓNAY ETEKΦEPE MΠATECEI EBOA ZNCΩMA EBOA XEMΠOY CNAΠOT ENEBIX MΠNOYTE ZNOYTBEO. AYW OYNOYNOB NTAI O NAΦΩTE NAC MNNETOYAAE TPPOY EBOA XEOYNOB MΠAPΘEHOCTE ECTEBHY ZABOA NTΩAM NIM NTE-THKOCMOC.

10. ANOK ΔE NTETICΩTM ENAI AIPIME MMATE EMAΦA AYW ΠEXAC NAI XEMΠEPPIME ETBETI2WB MALLON ΔE PAΦE NAK XEEKNATAAC NAΦPON MΠEXC NEPEΦEPNOKE ΓAP NETEΦWE EPIME EPOOY EYΦANMOY XEEYNAΠOT EYKOAACTC ΦAENEZ XEAYKΩ NCΦOY MΠEYΩNZ MAYAAAY AYEI EBOA ZMΠEIBIOC EYΦOYEIT AYW NEYTEANTEON ΦOYEIT EMN2HME NTOOTOY ETPEYXIOOP MAYAAAY EMHTPOFH OYH2 NCΦOY AYW ON EY-ZMΠKAZ ENΦAPHA EMNMOOY NTOOTOY EMNZOITE ZIΦOY.

11. ONTOS ON EYTHIT EΠMA MΠΩB MHTPIME MHTKAKE

(and) Mary, the Mother of the Lord, sitting upon it. She called to me, saying : « Stephen the archdeacon, peace (be) to thee ». Then she said to me : « Arise, go in peace quickly unto thy only daughter. Behold, it is seven days that she lieth sick and her mother being troubled at heart, desiring to know where thou art. They (the mother and the daughter) know not the place in which thou art that they may send for thee (while) thou art not yet far from them, that thou mayest see thy daughter ere she departeth from the body, for to-day she will go in purity into the hands of God, and there shall be great honour for her with all the Saints, because she is a great virgin, pure (and) free from every stain of this world ».

10. And when I heard these (things), I wept exceedingly much, and She said to me : « Weep not concerning this matter but rather rejoice that thou wilt give her as a gift to Christ; for it is fitting to weep for the sinners when they die, because they shall go to punishment for ever, because they have left behind their only life (and) they have gone forth from this life, being empty; and their vessels also being empty; there being no fare in their hands that they may pass over alone, there being no provision following them, and also while being parched on earth, having no water, having no garments upon them.

11. « Truly also they go to the place of cold and weeping and outer dark-

ETZIBOA MHTPOZB2 NNOBZE EMHTOOCYE ZNPATOY EYMOOCWE ZNTEZIH ETIMAY ETMEZ NCOYPE ZIMATOY ZIΦYPION NIM EMNAPOM ZNNEYBIX AAA NAI NETOYΦOPEI MMOY AYW ECOYH2 NCΦOY NAITPIONIA MHTTATAAAAIA MHTMNTXACI2HT MHTMNTABEPOME MHTKECEPE NNEZYAONH. TENOY ΔE MΠEPPIME ETBETEKΦEPE XETANAI ΓAP NTEIMINETE TMHTPO NNMPIHYE. NEAIKAIOS ΓAP ΦWE AN EPIME EPOOY XE-NTAYEI EBOA ZNOYEWTEKO EYMHTRPO ECOYOWC EBOA ΦAENEZ MNOYKAPHONOMIA NATBWA EBOA.

12. AYW NTEPECXENAI NAITTAPΘENOC ETOYAAE MARIA ACΠOT EZPAI ENMPIHYE. ANOK ΔE AITFOYN AIΦANA AIMOCWE EΠMA NTACZIME MNNAΦHP¹ AIBENTC EΠECCAΦQΠE ECΦONE KATAΘE NTAMARIA XOOC NAI.

13. NEPOME ΔE ETMΠBOA MΠHI NEYCOOYN MMOI AN NEYPIME EYXW MMOC XEMNOYTE TMNOOY MΠEWT NTEIΦEPE ΦHM XEACOYΦ ENAY EPQ MΠATECEI EBOA ZNCΩMA. AYW XEKAC NNECEPKOYI NZHT ECNHY EBOA ZNCΩMA ΦANTEC.

¹ Read TAYEPE.

ness and gnashing of teeth, there being no shoes on their feet (with which) to walk in that way which is full of thorns and poison and every wild beast, there being no staff in their hands; but these (things) are (the things) which they carry and which follow them, namely, fornication and slanderings and pride and boastfulness and also the rest of the pleasures (of the flesh). And now, weep not for thy daughter, for she belongeth to those of this kind, (of whom) is the Kingdom of the Heavens⁴. For it is not fitting to weep for the righteous, because they go forth from a prison to a vast kingdom for ever, and to an unending inheritance ».

12. And when the Holy Virgin Mary had said these (things), she departed to the Heavens. And I arose (and) I prayed. I walked to the place (in which) were my wife and my daughter⁵. I found that (it was) the⁶ seventh (day) she was sick even as Mary had said to me.

13. And the men who were outside the house did not recognize me. They were weeping, saying : « God send the father of this little daughter, because she hath desired to see him ere she goeth forth from (the) body and so that she may not be faint-hearted, while departing from (the) body, until she

⁴ Cf. Marc., x, 14.

⁵ MS. reads 'children'.

⁶ Lit. 'her'.

ΠΑΡΑΓΕ ΝΝΕΙΧΑΧΕ ΕΤΖΕΝΝΕΖΙΟΟΥΕ. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ
ΧΕΪΡΗΝΗ ΝΗΤΗ. ΝΤΟΟΥ ΔΕ ΖΩΟΥ ΟΝ ΠΕΧΑΥ ΧΕΪΡΗΝΗ ΜΠΕΚ-
ΠΗΑ ΑΚΕΙ ΖΝΟΥΤΩΨ ΕΝΑΝΟΥΨ. ΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΠΕΝΤΑΓΤΗΝΝΟΟΥΚ
ΝΑΝ ΧΕΚΑΣ ΕΚΕΝΑΥ ΕΤΕΚΨΕΕΡΕ ΝΚΕΣΟΠ ΑΥΩ ΝΟΝΑΥ ΕΡΟΚ
ΖΩΩΚ. ΑΛΗΘΩΣ ΠΕΤΕΝΨΑΝΑ ΕΡΟΨΠΕ ΠΑΙ ΧΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΔΩΨΤ
ΕΧΝΤΗΝΤΕΒΗΗΝ ΝΤΕΚΨΕΕΡΕ ΚΟΥΙ ΕΙΣ ΣΑΨΩ ΝΖΟΟΥ ΕΣΡΙΜΕ
ΧΕΣΙΟΥΨ ΕΝΑΥ ΕΠΑΕΙΨΤ ΜΠΑΤΑΜΟΥ. ΕΚΣΟΟΥΝ ΤΩΝ ΡΩ
ΕΙΣ ΑΨΠΕ ΠΤΟΠΟΣ ΕΤΕΚΨΟΟΠ ΝΖΗΤΩ ΕΙΣ ΝΙΜ ΠΕΝΤΑΓΤΑΜΟΚ
ΕΠΙΟΥΨ. ΑΛΛΑ ΖΩΜΕΟΣ ΜΕΡΕΠΧΟΕΙΣ ΚΩ ΝΣΩΨ ΝΝΕΤΖΕΛΠΙΖΕ
ΕΡΟΨ.

14. ΕΥΧΩ ΔΕ ΝΝΑΙ ΑΠΨΤ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΑΗ ΑΙΝΑΥ ΕΤΑΨΕΕΡΕ
ΕΡΕΟΥΜΗΗΨΕ ΣΟΟΥΖ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΥΚΨΤΕ ΕΡΟΣ. ΝΤΕΡΟΥΝΑΥ ΔΕ
ΕΡΟΙ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΑΥΡΙΜΕ ΖΝΟΥΝΟΔ ΝΝΕΖΠΕ. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ
ΧΕΜΠΕΡΡΙΜΕ ΟΥΔΕ ΗΠΕΡΨ ΕΒΟΛ ΕΤΒΕΤΔΙΝΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΝΣΩΜΑ
ΝΤΑΨΕΕΡΕ ΚΑΙΓΑΡ ΚΑΤΑΠΣΩΜΑΤΙΚΟΝ ΜΠΕΣΨΩΨΤ ΝΛΑΑΥ.
ΠΕΙΚΕΟΥΑ ΟΝ ΜΝΨΔΟΜ ΜΜΟΝ ΕΚΨΑΥ ΜΜΟΨ ΚΑΤΑΠΨΑΧΕ

has passed those enemies who are in the ways ». And I said to them :
« Peace (be) to you ». They moreover, themselves also said, « Peace (be)
to thy spirit. Thou hast come at the right ⁷ time. God (it is) Who hath sent
thee to us, so that thou mightest see thy daughter once more, and that she
might also see thee. In truth, what we pray to Him is this : « God, look
upon the wretchedness of Thy little daughter. Behold, it is seven days that
she weepeth, saying : I desire to see my father ere I die. Whence dost thou
know, indeed what is the place in which thou art (sic) ⁸ living, or who
hath told thee the news? But, however, the Lord is not wont to forsake
those who hope in Him ».

14. And while they were saying these (things), I went into my house,
(and) I saw my daughter, a multitude being assembled around her. And when
they saw me they all wept in great mourning but I said to them : « Weep
not, neither cry aloud on account of the departure from (the) body. For
she was not in need of any thing with regard to the body. This other matter,
also, we are not able to avert according to the word of our spirit bearing
fathers : « Who shall be able to hinder flowing water or who shall be able
to restrain the spirit of God that He might not cause it to go to Him ⁹ ».

⁷ Lit. 'good'.

⁸ Read 'he is'. This question is apparently addressed to the daughter.

⁹ Cf. Job, xxxviii, 25 and xxxiv, 14. E. PORCHER, *Le Livre de Job. Version copte bohairique*, in P.O., t. XVIII, fasc. 2, pp. [116] 324, [102] 310 and also P. A. CIASCA, *Sacrorum Bibliorum fragmenta Copto-sahidica Musei Borgiani* (Romae 1889), Vol. II, pp. 62, 56,

ΝΝΕΝΕΙΟΤΕ ΜΠΗΑΤΟΦΟΡΟΣ. ΝΙΜ ΠΕΤΝΑΕΨΚΩΛΥ ΝΟΥΜΟΟΥ
ΕΨΩΨΚ Η ΝΙΜ ΠΕΤΝΑΕΨΑΜΑΖΤΕ ΜΠΕΠΗΑ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΤΗΚΑΑΨ
ΕΠΨΤ ΕΡΑΤΩ. ΝΤΩΤΗ ΓΑΡ ΑΤΕΤΗΜΕΡΙΤΣ ΜΠΕΙΚΟΥΙ ΝΟΥΟΕΨ
ΑΥΩ ΝΤΩΤΗ ΑΝ ΝΤΕΤΝΟΥΨ ΑΝ ΕΤΡΕΣΨΩΡΧ ΕΡΨΤΗ ΑΛΛΑ
ΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΤΣΟΟΥΝ ΜΠΤΒΒΟ ΜΠΕΣΖΗΤ ΝΤΟΨ ΑΨΨΙΝΕ ΝΣΩΣ.
ΑΥΩ ΪΣΟΟΝ ΧΕ ΑΥΟΥΨ ΕΥΣΟΒΤΕ ΝΝΕΣΜΑΝΨΨΠΕ ΑΥΩ ΝΕΣ-
ΚΕΨΥΑΗ ΕΤΤΑΕΙΝΥ ΑΥΣΤΕΦΑΝΟΥ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΕΤΡΕΣΨΨΤ ΕΖΟΥΝ
ΝΖΗΤΟΥ ΑΥΩ ΝΣΕΡΑΨΕ ΝΜΜΑΣ ΝΔΙΝΕΨΗΡΕ ΜΠΟΥΟΕΙΝ.

15. ΕΤΕΙ ΔΕ ΕΡΕΠΜΗΗΨΕ ΡΙΜΕ ΑΨΚΟΤΩ ΝΔΙΠΖΑΓΙΟΣ ΑΠΑ
ΣΤΕΦΑΝΟΣ ΕΧΝΤΕΨΨΕΕΡΕ ΑΨΝΑΥ ΕΡΟΣ ΕΣΨΤΡΤΨ ΕΑΤΕΥ-
ΝΟΥ ΝΑΝΑΓΚΗ ΜΠΜΟΥ ΤΑΖΟΣ. ΑΝΕΪΥΧΗ ΝΝΩΗΡΟΝ ΕΤΕΝΑΙΝΕ
ΝΕΝΤΑΥΕΙ ΝΣΩΣ ΕΕΙΝΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΤΕΣΪΥΧΗ. ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΥΝΟΥ
ΑΨΨΕΙ ΝΝΕΣΒΑΛ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΖΑΝΟΥΙ ΑΣΝΑΥ ΕΡΟΙ ΑΝΕΣΒΑΛ ΪΡΜΕΙΗ.
ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΣ ΧΕΜΠΕΡΡΙΜΕ ΤΑΨΕΕΡΕ ΟΥΔΕ ΜΠΕΡΕΜ-
ΚΑΖ ΝΖΗΤ ΕΡΚΩ ΝΣΩ ΜΠΕΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΕΤΜΕΖ ΝΧΙΝΔΟΝΣ. ΑΝΟΝ
ΓΑΡ ΤΗΡΗ ΤΕΝΝΑΕΝΚΟΤΚ ΝΤΕΝΕΙ ΨΑΡΟ. ΠΕΝΤΑΓΤΑΖΟ Ψ
ΤΑΨΕΕΡΕ ΨΝΑΤΑΖΟΝ ΤΗΡΕΝ ΕΡΕΠΟΥΑ ΠΟΥΑ ΔΕΕΤ ΕΤΕΨΟΥ-
ΝΟΥ. ΝΕΤΟΥΨΜ ΓΑΡ ΑΥΩ ΕΤΣΩ ΖΜΠΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΜΕΥΚΑΑΥ
ΖΝΤΕΥΤΡΟΦΗ. ΝΕΤΟΥΝΟΨ ΔΕ ΟΝ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΝΣΕΝΑΚΑΑΥ ΑΝ
ΖΜΠΕΥΟΥΝΟΨ. ΝΤΑΝΙΜ ΓΑΡ ΕΝΕΖ ΔΩ ΝΑΤΜΟΥ ΧΕΚΑΣ ΝΝΑ-

For ye loved her for a short time and ye desire not that she should be
separated from you. But God Who knoweth the purity of her heart, Him-
self hath asked for her. And I know that her dwelling-places are already
prepared, and her glorious gates too are garlanded that she may enter
within them, and that the children of light may rejoice with her ».

15. And the multitude were still weeping, (when) Saint Apa Stephen
turned to his daughter. He saw her troubled, the time of the agony of
death having come upon her. The rational souls, namely those who came
for her to bring forth her soul ... ¹⁰, and immediately she lifted up her
eyes towards mine. She saw me (and) her eyes shed tears. And I said to
her : « Weep not, my daughter, nor be grieved to leave behind thee this
world which is full of iniquity, for we all shall sleep, and come to thee.
That which hath come upon thee, O my daughter, will come upon us all;
everyone awaiteth his hour. For those who eat and drink in this world
are not wont to keep their food and those also who rejoice will not keep
their joy. For who hath remained for ever without death that we our-

¹⁰ Verb missing.

ΘΑΡΙΝ² ΖΩΦΝ ΝΤΕΝΧΟΟC ΧΕΝΤΕΝΝΑΜΟΥ ΑΝ. ΕΦΧΕΤΠΕ
ΜΝΠΚΑΖ ΜΝΝΕCΤΟΙΧΙΟΝ ΜΝΝΙΤΟΟΥ CΕΝΑΒΩΑ ΕΒΟΛ ΑΝΟΝ
ΖΩΦΝ ΕΙΕ ΝΤΕΝΝΑΒΩΑ ΕΒΟΛ ΑΝ. 16. ΕΙCΟΟΥΝ ΡΩ Ω ΤΑΦΕΕΡΕ
ΧΕΜΕΝΖΗΥ ΖΗΠΚΟCΜΟC ΝCΑΘΑΙΨΙC. ΕΤΒΕΠΑΙ ΜΠΙΩ ΖΑΤΝ-
ΤΗΥΤΝ ΑΛΛΑ ΑΙΔΑΝΑΧΩΡΕΙ ΝΑΙ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΤΟΟΥ ΕΥΜΑ ΝΧΑΙΕ
ΦΑ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΟΟΥ ΝΖΟΥ. ΕΑΙΕΜΠΩΑ ΜΠΕΙΝΟC ΝΤΑΙΟ ΑCΕΙ
ΦΑΡΟΙ ΝΑΙΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΠΑΡΘΕΝΟC ΤΜΑΥ ΜΠΑΧΟΕΙC ΙC ΑCΤΑΜΟΙ
ΕΤΒΗΗΤΕ ΦΑΝΤΑΚΕΡΑΤ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΤΑΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΦΑΡΟ ΤΑΦΕΕΡΕ
ΜΜΕΡΙΤ. 17. ΜΠΕΡΕΡΖΟΤΕCΕ ΤΑΦΕΕΡΕ ΕΡΕΤΜΑΥ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC
ΜΕ ΜΜΟ ΖΝΟΥΜΕ. ΑΙΕΙ ΓΑΡ ΕCΑCΩΑΕ ΕΤΒΕΤΟΥΔΙΝΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ
ΖΝCΩΜΑ ΑΛΛΑ ΟΥΝΤΑΙ ΜΜΑΥ ΝΟΥΚΟΥΙ ΝΑΥΠΗ ΧΕΜΠΕΛΑΑΥ
ΖΝΝΕΤΟΥΑΑΒ ΝΑΥ ΕΠΜΟΥ ΝΝΕΥΩΗΡΕ ΝCΕΡΙΜΕ ΕΧΩΟΥ ΑΛΛΑ
ΝΕΩΗΡΕ ΝΤΟΟΥ ΝΕΦΑΥΡΙΜΕ ΕΧΝΝΕΥΕΙΟΤΕ. ΟΥΝΟC ΝΑΥΠΗ
ΑΛΗΘCΠΕ ΖΝΕΙΟΤΕ ΕΥΡΙΜΕ ΕΧΝΝΕΥΩΗΡΕ ΕΥΝΗΥ ΕΒΟΛ
ΖΝCΩΜΑ. ΠΑΛΙΝ ΟΝ ΤΡΑΦΕ ΜΠΟΟΥ ΕΠΕΖΟΥΟ ΧΕΑΙΧΟΟΥ
ΝΟΥΚΑΡΙΠΟC ΖΑΤΑΖΕ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΝΜΠΗΥΕ.

18. ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΕΔΧΩ ΜΜΟΥ ΕΡΕΝΕΦΒΑΑ ΤΡΜΕΙΝ ΑΥΩ ΝΕΤΖΜ-
ΠΕΚΩΤΕ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΕΥΡΙΜΕ. ΜΝΝCΩC ΑΚΚΟΤΑ ΕΧΝΤΕΦΩCΕΡΕ

2 Read *nnen*.

thelves¹¹ shall *dare* to say that we shall not die? If the heaven and the earth and their *elements* and the mountains shall be dissolved, shall we ourselves also not be dissolved? 16. I know, indeed, *O* my daughter, that there is no profit in this *world*, apart from *tribulation*. Therefore I did not stay with you, *but withdrew* myself to a mountain in a desert place until this day. I have been worthy of this great honour : Mary the *Virgin* the Mother of my Lord Jesus Christ, came to me. She informed me about thee so that I set forth (and) came out to thee, my beloved daughter. 17. Therefore, fear not, my daughter, since the Mother of the Lord loveth thee in truth. *For* I came to console thee on account of thy departure from the *body*, *but* I have little *grief*, for none among the Saints saw the death of his children and wept over them, *on the contrary* the sons themselves were wont to weep over their parents. A great *grief* is it, *in truth*, that parents should weep over their children, when they depart from (the) *body*. *On the contrary*, rather I rejoice to-day that I have sent a *fruit* before me to the heavens ».

18. *And* while saying these (things) his eyes shed tears and all those who were round him were weeping. Afterwards, he turned to his daughter (and)

¹¹ Coptic reads *nnn* = I shall not,

ΠΕΧΑΔ ΝΑC ΧΕΜΠΕΡΑΥΠΕΙ Ω ΤΑΦΕΕΡΕ ΝΤΕΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΧΕΜΕΡΕ-
ΑΛΑΥ ΝΑΦΧΕ ΑΜΑΖΤΕ ΜΜΟ ΕΡΝΗΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΝCΩΜΑ ΕΤΒΕ ΧΕ-
ΜΠΕΡCΟΥΕΝΜΑΝΕΝΚΟΤΚ ΝΖΟΥΤ ΕΝΕΖ ΖΗΠΤΡΕΧΙΨΕ ΜΠΟΥ-
ΟΕΙΝ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΜΠΠΕΖΛΟC ΜΠΑΡΘΕΝΙΑ. ΕΠΕΙΑΝ ΠΟΥΟΕΙΝ
ΕΤΝΑΝΟΥC ΕΦΕΙΡΕ ΝΤΗΝΤΟΥΟΕΙΕ ΜΠΚΑΖ ΚΑΛΩC ΦΑΚΠΩΡΚ
ΝΝΕΝΤΗC ΜΠΚΑΖ ΝΚΩΦΠΕ ΕΚΤΕΒΗΥ ΕΤΗΜΕΛΑΑΥ ΝΧΒΙΝ ΝΖΗΤΑ
ΝΑΖΡΜΠΕΚΧΟΕΙC. ΤΑΙΤΕ ΤΟΥΖΕ ΖΩΩΤΕ Ω ΤΑΦΕΕΡΕ ΕΑΡΤΒΒΟ
ΖΑΒΟΛ ΝΤΩΑΜ ΝΙΜ ΑΥΩ ΜΝΑΑΑΥ ΝΧΒΙΝ ΖΝΤΟΥΚΑΑΑΖΗ ΜΝΤΟΥ-
ΤΥΧΗ ΝΑΖΡΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΙC ΠΟΥΠΑΤΦΕΛΕΕΤ ΝΑΤΜΟΥ ΦΑΕΝΕΖ.

19. ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΡΕΚΧΕΝΑΙ ΠΕΧΑΔ ΧΕΤΩΟΥΝ ΝΤΕΝΦΑΛΑ ΑΥΩ
ΝΤΕΝΤΩΕΖ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΧΝΤΑΙΝΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΝCΩΜΑ ΝΤΕΙΤΥΧΗ.
ΑΚΤΩΟΥΝ ΔΕ ΑΚΦΑΛΑ ΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΚΧΩ ΜΜΟC ΧΕΠΑΧΟΕΙC ΙC
ΠΕΧC ΠΑΤΜΟΥ ΜΑΥΑΑΚ ΠΜΟΝΟΓΕΝΗC ΝΩΗΡΕ ΝΤΕΠΩΤ
ΠΕΝΤΑΚΠΑΑCCE ΜΠΦΟΡΙΠ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΑΔΑΜ ΚΑΤΑΠΕΦΕΙΝΕ ΜΝ-
ΤΕΚΖΙΚΩΝ ΠΕΤΕΜΝΑΑΑΥ ΜΜΝΤΑΤΔΟΜ ΖΑΖΤΗΚ ΤΕΝΠΑΡΑΚΑΛΕΙ
ΜΜΟΚ ΠΜΑΙΡΩΜΕ ΝΑΓΑΘΟC ΜΠΕΡΟΒΩΚ ΕΡΟΝ ΟΥΔΕ ΜΠΕΡΟΥΕ
ΖΑΒΟΛ ΝΤΕΙΚΟΥΙ ΝΦΕΕΡΕ ΑΛΛΑ ΔΩΩΤ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΧΩC. ΜΠΕΡΤΡΕC-
ΟΥΟΡΤΡ ΖΝΤΕCΑΙΝΕΙ ΦΑΡΟΚ. ΜΑΡΕΠΧΑΧΕ ΧΙΩΠΕ ΝCΕΩΤΟΜ
ΕΡΩΚ. ΜΑΡΕΠΓΑΤΗΓΟΡΟC ΧΙΩΠΕ ΝΚΠΩΤ ΕΠΟΥΕ. ΜΑΡΕΚΕΙ
ΦΑΡΟC ΖΝΟΥΔΕΠΗ ΝΑΠΕΓΑΓΓΕΛΟC ΝΑΓΑΘΟC ΜΙΧΑΗΛ ΝΚΧΙΤC

said to her : « *Grieve* not, *O* my daughter, that thou departest, for no weakening will take hold of thee, while departing from (the) *body*, because thou hast never known the couch of a man when thou hast a taste of the light of God and the sweetness of *virginity*. When the *good* husbandman prepareth *well* the cultivation of the earth, he is wont to pluck out the weeds of the earth that it may be clean, in order not to have any blemish in it before his lord. This is even thy condition, *O* my daughter. Thou art purified from every defilement and there is no blemish in thy womb and thy *soul* before the Lord Jesus, thine Immortal Bridegroom for ever ».

19. And when he had said these (things), he said : « Arise and let us pray and beseech God on account of departure of this *soul* from (the) *body* ». And he arose (and) prayed to God, saying : « My Lord Jesus Christ, the Only Immortal (and) the *Only begotten* Son of the Father, Who *fashioned* the first man Adam *according to* Thy¹² likeness and Thine¹² *image*, Whom nothing is impossible, we *beseech* Thee, *God* Lover of man, forget us not, *neither* be far from this little daughter, *but* look upon her, cause her not to be troubled in her coming unto Thee. Let the enemy be ashamed, and his mouth be shut. Let the *accuser* be ashamed and flee far

¹² The Coptic reads 'His'.

ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΤΦΑΙΡΕ ΝΝΕΚΕΣΟΟΥ. ΜΠΕΡΑΑΣ ΝΩΜΗΟ ΕΠΕΚΜΑΝ-
ΦΕΛΕΕΤ ΑΛΛΑ ΜΑΡΕΣΟΥΝΟQ ΜΜΟΣ ΖΝΤΕΚΚΛΗΡΟΝΟΜΙΑ ΕΤΝΑ-
ΜΟΥΝ ΕΒΟΛ ΘΑΕΝΕΖ ΧΕΠΩΚΠΕ ΠΕΟΟΥ ΜΝΠΑΜΑΖΤΕ ΘΑΕΝΕΖ
ΝΕΝΕΖ ΖΑΜΗΝ.

20. ΝΖΩΣΟΝ ΔΕ ΕΥΦΑΝΑ ΑΤΚΟΥΙ ΝΦΕΕΡΕ ΕΜΤΟΝ ΜΜΟΣ
ΖΝΟΥΑΝΑΠΑΥΣΙC ΑC† ΜΠΕCΠΗΑ ΕΝΕΔΙΧ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΝCΟΥ-
ΦΟΜΓ ΜΠΟΟΠΕ. ΑQΖΜΟΟC ΕΖΡΑΪ ΑQΤΡΕΥΚΩΦC ΜΜΟΣ ΑΥΧΙΤC
ΕΠΤΑΦΟC ΖΝΟΥΕΟΟΥ. ΝΤΕΡΕQΚΩ ΔΕ ΜΠΕCΣΩΜΑ ΖΗΠΤΑΦΟC
ΑQΚΟΤQ ΕΠΕQΜΑΝΩΦΠΕ ΕQΖΜΠΤΟΟΥ ΕQ†ΕΟΟΥ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ
ΕΧΝΖΩΒ ΝΙΜ ΝΤΑΥΦΩΠΕ ΑΥΩ ΝΕQΠΟΛΙΤΕΥΕ ΚΑΤΑΤΕQΑCΚΗ-
CΙC ΝΦΟΡΠ.

21. ΑCΦΩΠΕ ΔΕ ΟΝ ΝΟΥΖΟΟΥ ΕΙΕΙΡΕ ΝΝΑCΥΝΑΞΙC ΑΙQΕΙ
ΝΝΑΒΑΛ ΕΖΡΑΪ ΑΙΝΑΥ ΕΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΜΑΑΥ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΠΕΧΑC ΝΑΙ
ΧΕCΤΕΦΑΝΟC ΜΠΕΡΑΥΠΕΙ ΕΤΒΕΤΕΚΦΕΕΡΕ ΚΑΙΓΑΡ ΑCΕΜΠΦΑ
ΝΟΥΤΟΠΟC ΕQΤΑΙΝΥ ΑCΚΛΗΡΟΝΟΜΕΙ ΜΜΟQ. ΝΤΟΚ ΔΕ ΖΩΦΚ
CΩΤΗ ΕΠΕΙΦΑΧΕ Ε†ΝΑΧΟΟQ ΝΑΚ. ΕΙCΖΗΗΤΕ ΓΑΡ ΟΥΝΦΟΜΗΤ
ΝΡΩΜΕ ΝΗΥ ΝΑΚ ΝΡΑCΤΕ ΕΑΥΕΙΡΕ ΝΖΕΝΝΟQ ΜΠΑΡΑΠΤΩΜΑ-
ΦΟΠΟΥ ΕΡΟΚ ΝΓΚΑΘΗΓΕΙ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΖΝΤΕCΒΩ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΕΒΟΛ
ΧΕΑΠΧΑΧΕ ΕΦΟΟΥ ΡΑΦΕ ΕΖΡΑΪ ΕΧΦΟΥ ΑQΟΥΝΟQ ΕΧΗΠΖΩΒ

away. Let Thy good Angel Michael come in haste to her that he may take her into the fold of Thy sheep. Cause her not be a stranger to Thy bride-chamber, but her rejoice in Thy perpetual inheritance for ever, for Thine is the glory and the power for ever and ever. Amen ».

20. And as they were praying, the little daughter went to (her) rest in repose. She gave her spirit into the hands of the Lord on the third of Poope¹³. He sat down (and) he caused them to prepare her for burial, (and) they took her to the tomb in glory. And when he had laid her body in the tomb, he returned to his dwelling-place which was on the mountain, giving glory to God for every thing that had happened and he conducted himself according to his former asceticism.

21. And it happened again one day that while I was performing my synaxis, I lifted up my eyes (and) I saw Mary the Mother of the Lord. She said to me : « Stephen, grieve not on account of thy daughter for she hath merited an honourable place, (and) hath inherited it. And thou thyself hearken to this word which I shall say to thee. For behold, three men are coming to thee to-morrow who have committed great transgressions, receive them unto thee (and) instruct them in the teaching of the Lord, because the evil enemy hath rejoiced over them (and) hath been glad at the deed

¹³ I.e. month of Bābeh 4. (ΠΑΟΠΕ).

ΝΤΑQΑΑQ ΠΟΥΑ ΠΟΥΑ ΚΑΤΑΠΕQΝΟΒΕ ΜΑΡΟΥCΟΥΕΝΠΕΥΧΟ-
ΕΙC ΝCΕΕΙΡΕ ΝΟΥΚΑΡΠΟC ΕQΕΜΠΦΑ ΝΤΗΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ ΧΕΚΑC
ΝΤΕΠΧΑΧΕ ΧΙΦΠΕ ΝΤΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΖΩΦQ ΧΙΕΟΟΥ ΕΛQΧΙ ΝΤΗΕΤ-
ΑΝΟΙΑ ΝΝΡΕQΕΡΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΟΟΤΟΥ. ΟΥΦΩΝΖΤΗQΠΕ ΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΑΥΩ
ΟΥΝΑΗΤΠΕ ΝQΟΥΦΩ ΑΝ ΕΤΡΕΑΑΑΥ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΜΟΥ ΖΝΝΕΥΝΟΒΕ.

22. ΑCΦΩΠΕ ΔΕ ΜΠΕQΡΑCΤΕ ΑΥΕΙ ΦΑΡΟΙ ΝΔΙΠΦΟΜΗΤ ΝΡΩΜΕ.
ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΝΕΙΠΡΟCΚΑΡΤΗΡΕΙ ΕΙΔΩΦΤ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗΤΟΥ ΚΑΤΑΘΕ
ΝΤΑΥΧΟΟC ΝΑΙ. ΑΥΕΙ ΕΥΖΟCΕ ΕΥΜΟΟΦΕ ΖΝΤΕΖΗ ΑΥΖΜΟΟC
ΜΠΚΟΛ ΜΠΡΟ ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΡΟΥΕΜΤΟΝ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΝΟΥΚΟΥΙ ΑΥΩ ΑΙ-
CΩΤΗ ΕΡΟΟΥ ΕΥΕΝΖΟΥΝ ΕΥΦΑΧΕ ΕΖΕΝΠΑΡΑΝΟΜΙΑ ΝΤΑΥΑΑΥ
ΕΥΦΑΧΕ ΜΝΝΕΥΕΡΗΥ ΕΥΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΧΕΜΑΡΕΝΠΩΤ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΙ-
ΜΑ ΜΠΙΝΑΥ ΝΤΕΝΕΝΚΟΤΚ ΦΑΦΩΡΠ ΧΕΑΡΟΥΖΕ ΦΩΠΕ. ΑΥΩ
ΕΡΦΑΝΦΩΡΠ ΦΩΠΕ ΤΕΝΝΑΠΩΤ ΕΠΗΙ ΜΠΡΗΜΑΟ ΝΤΕΝCΥΛΑ
ΜΜΟQ ΚΕΠΕΡ ΕΝΟΝΖ ΕΠΙΖΩΒ ΠΑΙ ΝΧΙΝΤΕΝΜΗΤΚΟΥΙ.

23. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΑΙΟΥΦΩΝ ΜΠΡΟ ΑΙΕΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΦΑΡΟΟΥ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ
ΧΕ†ΡΗΝΗ ΝΗΤΗ ΝΑCΗΥ, ΠΧΟΕΙC ΕQΕΦΩΠΕ ΝΜΗΗΤΗ. ΠΕΧΑΥ
ΧΕΚΝΑΦΟΠΗ ΕΡΟΚ ΜΠΙΝΑΥ. ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ ΧΕCΕ ΑΥΩ ΑΙΧΙΤΟΥ
ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΑΜΑΝΦΩΠΕ. ΑΠΩΤ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΕΠΜΑ ΕΥΕΝΚΟΤΚ

which each one hath done in his sin. Let them know their Lord and produce fruit worthy of repentance¹⁴ so that the enemy may be shamed and God Himself be glorified Who hath accepted the repentance of sinners. God is merciful and compassionate, and He desireth not that any man die in his sins »¹⁵.

22. And it happened on the morrow (that) three men came to me. And I was persevering in looking out for them even as it had been said unto me. They arrived being weary (from) walking in the way, (and) they sat outside the door. And when they rested themselves a little and I, being within, heard them talking about the transgressions which they had committed, saying to one another : « Let us enter this place at this hour and let us sleep until morning, as evening has come, and when it is morning, we will go to the house of this rich man and rob him, for also¹⁶ we are living by this means, since our childhood ».

23. And I opened the door, (and) I went out to them. I said to them, « Peace (be) unto you, my brethren, the Lord will be with you ». They said : « Wilt thou receive us unto thee at this hour? ». I said to them : « Yea ». And I took them inside my dwelling-place. I entered the place in which they

¹⁴ Cf. Matth., III, 8.

¹⁵ Cf. Jez., XVIII, 23.

¹⁶ Read probably καὶ γάρ.

ΝΗΤΗΡ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ ΧΕΝΑΦΗΡΕ ΜΑΤΑΜΟΙ ΧΕΝΤΕΤΝ ΖΕΝΕΒΟΛ
ΤΩΝ ΕΙΕ ΕΤΕΤΝΠΗΤ ΕΤΩΝ.

24. ΝΤΟΟΥ ΔΕ ΑΥΚΑΡΩΟΥ ΤΗΡΟΥ. ΠΕΧΕΟΥΑ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΗΤΟΥ
ΧΕΩΝΤΟΣ ΠΑΕΙΩΤ ΝΤΑΝΕΙ ΕΝΧΙΟΥΕ ΑΥΩ ΕΝΣΥΛΑ ΜΠΕΤΗ-
ΠΩΝ ΑΝΠΕ. ΑΝΑΥ ΧΕΟΥΠΕ ΠΕΚΖΩΕ ΝΜΗΑΝ ΤΕΝΟΥ. ΑΥΕΙΝΕ
ΔΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΟΥΣΚΕΟΣ ΜΠΕΝΙΠΕ ΕΦΕΝΤΟΟΤΟΥ ΕΥΟΥΩΦ ΕΜΟΥ-
ΟΥΤ ΜΜΟΙ ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΥΝΟΥ ΑΝΕΥΔΙΧ ΤΩΣ ΑΥΕΡΘΕ ΝΝΙΩΝΕ
ΜΠΟΥΕΦΟΚΟΥ ΕΡΟΟΥ ΕΠΤΗΡΗ ΜΗΝΣΩΣ ΔΕ ΑΥΡΙΜΕ ΕΥΤΩΕΖ
ΜΜΟΙ ΧΕΠΕΝΕΙΩΤ ΝΑ ΝΑΝ.

25. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΠΕΧΑΙ ΝΑΥ ΧΕΕΖΟΜΟΛΟΓΕΙ ΝΝΕΤΝΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΑ-
ΤΕΤΝΑΑΥ ΑΥΩ ΑΝΟΚ ΉΝΑΤΩΕΖ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΝΚΝΑ ΝΗΤΝ ΑΠΦΟΡΠ
ΟΥΩΦΕ ΕΦΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΧΕΚΩ ΝΑΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΠΑΕΙΩΤ ΜΠΕΡΖΩΕ ΕΝΑ-
ΝΟΥΦ ΕΝΕΖ ΝΣΑΠΕΦΟΟΥ ΕΙΣΥΛΑ ΜΠΕΤΗΠΩΙ ΑΝΠΕ ΕΠΟΡ-
ΝΕΥΕ ΕΙΦΩΦΕ ΜΠΡΗ ΜΠΠΟΟΖ.

26. ΑΠΚΕΟΥΑ ΔΕ ΟΥΩΦΕ ΕΦΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΧΕΑΝΟΚ ΖΩΩΤ ΟΝ
Ω ΠΑΕΙΩΤ ΕΤΟΥΑΛΒ ΑΙΖΩΤΕ ΝΟΥΡΩΜΕ ΕΤΒΕΤΕΦCΖΙΜΕ ΦΑΝ-
ΤΑΕΝΚΟΤΚ ΝΜΗΑΣ ΧΩΡΙCΖΕΝΚΕΝΟΒΕ ΕΙΕΙΡΕ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΜΠΕΖΟΥΥ
ΜΠΤΕΥΦΗ ΕΜΕΙ΄CΟ ΖΗΛΑΑΥ ΝΝΟΒΕ ΝΦΑΙΛΑΦ. ΜΑΡΕΝΕΚΦΑΛΗ
ΕΤΟΥΑΛΒ ΤΑΖΟΙ ΧΕΑΝΑΝΟΒΕ ΑΦΑΙ ΕΠΕΖΟΥΟ. ΦΑΛΗ ΜΕΦΑΚ
ΝΤΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΡΟΥΝΑ ΝΜΜΑΙ.

were lying down (and) I said to them : « My sons, inform me whence ye are, or whither ye are going? ».

24. *But* they all remained silent. One of them said : « *Really*, my father we have come stealing and robbing that which is not ours. Behold, what is thy business with us now? » *And* they brought out an iron *tool* which they had with them, wishing to kill me. *And* immediately their hands became stiff and were like stones, (and) they could not move them at all. *And* afterwards they wept beseeching me, saying : « Our father, have pity upon us ».

25. *And* I said to them : « *Confess* your sins which ye have committed; and I shall pray to God to have pity upon you ». The first answered, saying : « Forgive me, my father, I have never done a good deed but rather evil (ones), *robbing* that which was not mine, *fornicating* (and) worshipping the Sun and the Moon ».

26. *And* the other one answered, saying : « I, myself also, O my holy father, have killed a man on account of his wife so that I might sleep with her, *apart from* other sins which I have committed by day and by night, (and) I am not wont to refrain from any of the sins which I am accustomed to commit. Let thy holy prayers touch me, because my sins have multiplied exceedingly. Pray, perhaps God may have mercy upon me ».

27. ΑΠΚΕΟΥΑ ΖΩΩΦ ΟΥΩΦΕ ΕΦΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΧΕΟΥΟΙ ΝΑΙ ΠΑΕΙΩΤ
ΟΥΝΟΒΤΕ ΠΙΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΑΙΑΑΦ. ΑΝΟΚ ΓΑΡ ΝΦΟΡΠ ΑΝΟΚ ΟΥΟΕΙΕ
ΕΙΕΡΖΩΕ ΝΟΥΡΩΜΕ ΖΑΠΑΒΕΚΗ· ΑΠΧΟΕΙC ΜΠΚΑΖ ΕΤΗΜΑΥ
ΜΠΦΕ ΝΜΜΑΙ ΝΟΥΖΟΥ ΕΤΒΕΟΥΚΑΤΑΦΡΟΝΗCΙC ΕΑΙΑC ΕΑΠ-
ΔΙΑΒΟΛΟC ΝΟΧC ΕΠΑΖΗΤ ΑΙΤΩΟΥΝ ΝΤΠΑΦΕ ΝΤΕΥΦΗ ΑΙ΄-
ΚΩΖΤ ΕΤΕΦΟΥCΙΑ ΝCΟΥΟ· ΝΕΦΤΕΝΟΟΥΕ ΑΙΧΙΤΟΥ ΕΥΠΟΛΙC
ΝΦΜΜΟ ΑΙΤΑΑΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΑΙΤΩΟΥΝ ΑΙΕΙ ΕΠΕΙΜΑ ΑΙΟΥΑΖΤ ΝCΑΠ-
ΚΕΡΩΜΕ CΝΑΥ ΜΠΑΡΑΝΟΜΟC ΑΙΜΕΤΕΧΕ ΝΜΜΑΥ ΕΠΧΙΟΥΕ
ΜΝΖΕΝΚΕΝΟΒ ΝΖΩΕ ΝΑCΕΒΗC. ΤΕΝΟΥ ΔΕ ΕΙC ΝΕΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΑ-
ΝΑΑΥ ΑΝΖΟΜΟΛΟΓΕΙ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΜΠΜΤΟ ΕΒΟΛ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΝΜΜΑΚ.
ΤΕΝΟΥΔΕ ΜΑΡΕΠΕΚΝΑ ΤΑΖΟΝ ΝΤΕΝΩ ΖΑΤΗΚ ΜΠΕΙΜΑ ³ ΑΥΩ
ΝΓΚΑΛΝ ΖΑΦΑΙΕC ΝΝΕΚΦΑΛΗ ΕΤΟΥΑΛΒ.

28. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΑΙΤΩΟΥΝ ΝΜΜΑΥ ΑΙΦΑΛΗ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΑΥΩ
ΝΤΕΥΝΟΥ. ΑΝΕΥΔΙΧ CΟΥΤΝ ΕΒΟΛ ΑΥΕΡΘΕ ΝΦΟΡΠ. ΑΝΟΚ
ΔΕ ΖΩΩΤ ΑΙΖΜΟΟC ΑΙΚΑΦΗΓΕΙ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΝΝΕΓΡΑΦΗ
ΕΤΟΥΑΛΒ ΕΙΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΝΑΥ ΧΕΕΡΦΑΝΠΡΩΜΕ ΕΡΝΟΒΕ ΝΙΜ ΝΦ-
ΚΟΤΦ ΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΜΕΦΦΕΙΩΠ ΝΜΜΑΦ.

29. ΑΥΩ ΑΙΦΙΝΕ ΝCΑΝΕΥΡΑΝ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΙΤΟΟΤΟΥ ΑΥΤΑΜΟΙ

³ § 27 des. - 34 inc. cf. I. GUIDI, in Rendiconti della R. Accad. dei Lincei. Classe di scienze morali, storiche e filol., 1887, p. 47-52.

27. The other one also answered, saying : « Woe unto me, my father. Great is the sin which I have committed, *for* I was, at first, a husbandman, working for a man for my wage. The master of that land chided me one day, on account of *disdain* which I showed, which the *Devil* had put into my heart. I arose at mid-night and I set fire to all his *crop* ¹⁷ of wheat, his beasts I took to a different ¹⁸ city (and) I sold them. I arose (and) I came to this place. I followed the two other *lawless* men, (and) I *took part* with them in stealing and in many other *godless* deeds. *And* now, behold, the sins which we have committed, we have *confessed* before God and thee. Now, moreover, let thy mercy reach us, that we may stay with you in this place. And place us beneath the shadow of thy holy prayers ».

28. *And* I arose with them (and) I prayed to God, and immediately their hands stretched out and became as before. *And* I myself sat down (and) *instructed* them in the Holy Scriptures, saying to them : « If a man commit every sin and turn to God, He (God) is not wont to make a reckoning with him ».

29. *And* I asked them their names (and) they informed me. The first

¹⁷ *Lit.* 'property'.

¹⁸ *Lit.* 'foreign'.

ΠΘΡΠΠΕ ΕΡΑΣΤΟΣ ΠΜΕΖCΝΑΥΠΕ ΩΝΗCΙΜΟΣ ΠΜΕΖΩΜΗΝΤ-
ΠΕ ΤΡΟΦΙΜΟΣ. ΑΥΩ ΝΤΟQ ΠΕΝΤΑQΩΠΠΕ ΝΗΜΑΙ ΖΗΠΗΜΑΝ-
ΩΠΠΕ ΝΟΥΩΤ ΕΝΩΜΩΕ ΜΗΝΟΥΤΕ.

30. ΜΗΝCΑ ΝΑΙ ΑΥΠΩΤ ΕΤΠΟΛΙC ΝΟΥΖΟΟΥ ΕΩΠΠ ΝΤΕΝΧΡΙΑ.
ΕΙCΖΗΗΤΕ ΑCΕΙ ΦΑΡΟΙ ΝΑΙΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΗΑΑΥ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΠΕΧΑC ΝΑΙ
ΧΕΝΑΙΑΤΚ ΝΤΟΚ CΤΕΦΑΝΟC ΠΩΩC ΝΡΕQΜΟΟΝΕ ΝΝΕCΟΟΥ
ΜΠΕΧC ΕQΚΩΤΕ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΕΠΧΟΕΙC· ΕΙCΖΗΗΤΕ ΓΑΡ ΟΥΝΩΜΗΝΤ
ΝΚΛΟΜ CΒΤΩΤ ΝΑΚ ΖΗΝΗΠΗΥΕ ΕΠΜΑ ΜΠΩΜΗΝΤ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΝΡΕQ-
ΕΡΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΑΚΤCΑΒΟΟΥ ΕΠΧΟΕΙC ΦΑΝΤΕΥΟΥΧΑΙ ΧΩΡΙC ΠΕ-
ΚΛΟΜ ΕΤΕΚΝΑΧΙΤQ ΖΗΤΗΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΖΑΤΕΚΜΑΡΤΥΡΙΑ. ΚΑΙ ΓΑΡ
ΟΥΝΖΕΝΝΟC ΝΤΑΛΔΟ ΝΑΩΠΠΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗΝΕΚΔΙΧ ΝΓΚΤΟ ΝΟΥ-
ΜΗΗΩΕ ΦΑΠΧΟΕΙC ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗΝΙΟΥΔΑΙ ΜΗΝΕΖΕΛΛΗΝ. ΜΗΝCΩC
CΕΝΑΔΩΩΤ ΕΡΟΚ ΝΑΙΝΙΟΥΔΑΙ ΧΕΑΚΚΥΡΙΖΕ ΜΠΡΑΝ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC
ΝCΕΤΩΟΥΝ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΧΩΚ ΝCΕΖΙΩΝΕ ΕΡΟΚ ΝΓΧΩΚ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΤΕΚ-
ΜΑΡΤΥΡΙΑ. ΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΝΑΪΟΥΝΟC ΝΕΟΟΥ ΜΠΕΚΡΑΝ ΜΠΕΚCΩΜΑ
ΕΒΟΛ ΧΕΑΚΩΠΡΙCΕ ΕΧΜΠΕQΡΑΝ QΝΑΤΡΕΥΚΩΤ ΝΑΚ ΝΟΥΜΑΡ-
ΤΥΡΙΟΝ ΕΥΕΡΠΠΕΕΥΕ ΝΑΚ ΝΦΑΕΝΕΖ. ΟΥΝΖΕΝΝΟC ΝΔΟΜ
ΝΑΩΠΠΕ ΖΗΠΜΑ ΕΤΟΥΝΑΤΑΥΕΠΕΚΡΑΝ ΕΧΩQ ΑΥΩ ΟΥΝΖΕΝ-
ΝΟC ΝΤΑΛΔΟ ΝΑΩΠΠΕ ΝΝΕΤΠΙCΤΕΥΕ ΕΡΟΚ. ΤΩΟΥΝΔΕ ΤΕΝΟΥ
ΜΠΠΕΙΚΕΩΜΗΝΤ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΕΤΗΜΜΑΚ ΩΝΗCΙΜΟC ΜΗΝΑΡΑCΤΟC

was Erastus, the second was Onesimus and the third was Trophimus, and it was he who dwelt with me in this very dwelling-place (and) were serving God.

30. After these things, they went to the *city* one day to buy our *deeds*, (and) behold, Mary the Mother of the Lord came to me. She said to me : « Blessed art thou Stephen, shepherd who pastureth the flock of Christ, turning them to the Lord. *For* behold, three crowns are prepared for thee in the Heavens in the place of these three sinful men whom thou hast instructed in the Lord until they have been saved, *apart from* the crown which thou wilt receive from God for thy *martyrdom*. *For also* there shall go forth great cures through thine hands, (and) thou shalt bring back a multitude to the Lord of the Jews and of the *Greeks*. Afterwards, the Jews will look to thee, for thou hast *preached* the Name of the Lord, and they will rise up against thee, and stone thee, and thou shalt accomplish thy *martyrdom*. God will give great glory unto thy name and thy *body*, because thou hast endured suffering for His Name. He will cause them a *Martyrium* to be built for thee (as) a memorial unto thee for ever. There shall be great miracles in the place in which thy name shall be invoked and there shall be great cures for those who *believe* in thee. Arise, moreover, now with these three other men who are with thee, Onesimus

ΜΗΝΤΡΟΦΙΜΟC ΝΤΕΤΝΠΩΤ ΦΑΝΑΠΟCΤΟΛΟC ΝΤΕΤΝΕΡΜΑΘΗ-
ΤΗC ΝΑΥ ΝΤΕΤΝΤΑΦΕΟΕΙΩ ΜΠΕΥΑΓΓΕΛΙΟΝ ΝΤΗΝΤΡΡΟ.

31. ΝΤΕΡΕCΩCΚ ΔΕ ΕCΖΜΟΟC ΖΗΠΗ ΕCΦΑΧΕ ΝΗΜΑΙ ΖΗΝΚΕ-
ΝΟC ΜΗΥCΤΗΡΙΟΝ ΕΤΕΙ ΕCΖΜΟΟC ΖΑΤΗ ΕCΦΑΧΕ ΝΗΜΑΙ ΑΥΕΙ
ΕΖΟΥΝ ΝΑΙΝΕΤΗΜΜΑΙ ΑΥΔΩΩΤ ΑΥΝΑΥ ΕΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΠΑΡΘΕΝΟC
ΕCΖΜΟΟC ΖΑΤΗ ΝΤΕΥΝΟΥ ΝΤΑCΝΑΥ ΕΡΟΟΥ ΑCΪ ΝΑΙ ΝΪΡΗΗΗ
ΑCΠΩΤ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΝΗΜΠΗΥΕ ΖΝΟΥΕΟΟΥ.

32. ΝΤΟΟΥ ΔΕ ΑΥΔΩ ΕΥΠΑΡΑΚΛΕΙ ΗΜΟΙ ΖΗΖΕΝΝΟC ΝCΟΠC
ΜΗΖΕΝΝΟC ΝΚΩΡΩ ΧΕΜΑΤΑΜΟΝ Ω ΠΕΝΕΙΩΤ ΧΕΝΗΜΤΕ ΤΕΙC-
ΖΗΜΕ ΕΤΦΑΧΕ ΝΗΜΑΚ. ΝΤΕΡΟΥΕΝΩΧΕ ΝΑΙ ΕΠΕΖΟΥΟ ΕΥΑ-
ΝΑΓΚΑΖΕ ΜΜΟΙ ΑΙΤΑΜΟΟΥ ΧΕΤΕΙCΖΗΜΕ ΝΤΑΤΕΤΗΝΑΥ ΕΡΟC
ΕCΦΑΧΕ ΝΗΜΑΙ ΤΑΙΤΕ ΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΗΑΑΥ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC. ΑΥΩ ΑΙΤΑΜΟΟΥ
ΕΝΕΦΑΧΕ ΝΤΑCΧΟΟΥ ΝΑΙ ΑΥΠΗΘΕ ΕΧΗΝΕCΦΑΧΕ ΑΥΪΕΟΟΥ
ΜΠΠΟΥΤΕ.

33. ΑΝΤΩΟΥΝ ΑΝΠΩΤ ΦΑΝΑΠΟCΤΟΛΟC ΑΝΜΑΘΗΤΕΥΕ ΖΑΡΑ-
ΤΟΥ ΑΥΩ ΑΝΩΠΠΕ ΖΗΤΗΠΠΕ ΜΠΩQΕCΝΟΟΥC ΜΜΑΘΗΤΗC.
ΜΗΝCΑΟΥΟCΙΩ ΔΕ ΑΥΚΡΜΡΜ ΩΠΠΕ ΖΗΤΗΠΠΕ ΝΝΕΟΥΕΕΙΝΗΝ
ΜΗΝΕΖΕΒΡΑΙΟC ΧΕΝCΕΪΖΤΗΥ ΑΝ ΕΝΕΤΕΡΑΨΩΖ ΜΠΠΩΩΤ
ΝΝΕΧΗΡΑ ΖΗΤΑΙΑΚΟΝΙΑ.

and Arastus and Trophimus and go to the *Apostles* and become *disciples* to them, and preach the *Gospel* of the Kingdom ».

31. And when She (the Virgin) had continued sitting in the house (and) speaking with me about other great *mysteries* (and) She was still sitting beside me speaking with me; those who were with me entered in. They looked (and) they saw Mary the *Virgin* sitting beside me, and immediately She saw them, She gave me the *peace* (and) departed to the Heavens in glory.

32. And they remained *beseeking* me with many prayers and many entreaties, saying : « Inform us, O our father, who was this woman who was speaking with thee? ». When they *oppressed* me exceedingly and *compelled* me, I informed them that this woman whom ye saw speaking to me was Mary the Mother of the Lord. And I informed them of the words which She had said to me. They were *convinced* of her words (and) they glorified God.

33. We arose (and) went to the *Apostles*. We became *disciples* at their feet and we were in number seventy-two *Disciples*. And after a time a murmuring happened among the *Greeks* and the *Hebrews*, because they were not attending to those who were in need and want among the *widows* in the *ministry*.

34. ΑΠΙΜΝΤCΝΟΟΥC ΝΑΠΟCΤΟΛΟC ΜΟΥΤΕ ΕΠΙΘΥΕCΝΟΟΥC ΜΜΑ-ΘΗΤΗC ΠΕΧΑΥ ΝΑΝ ΖΙΟΥCΟΠ ΔΕCΩΠΤ ΝΦΑΩQ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΝΖΗΤΤΗΥΤΝ ΜΜΑΙCΕΩ ΕΖΕΝΧΑCΙΖΗΤ ΑΝΝΕ ΕΖΕΝΡΕQΚΑΤΑΛΑ-ΛΕΙ ΑΝΝΕ ΑΛΛΑ ΕΖΕΝΕΡΓΑΤΗCΝΕ ΝΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΟC ΝCΕΩΠΕ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΧΝΝΕΧΡΙΑ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΜΝΝΕΧΡΗΜΑ ΜΝΤΕΧΡΙΑ ΤΗΡC ΝΤΕΚ-ΚΑΗCΙΑ ΝCΕQΠΡΟΟΥQ ΜΝΕΧΗΡΑ ΜΝΝΕΤΕΡΔΡΩΖ ΑΥΩ ΝCΕ-ΤΡΥΦΑ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΖΝΟΥΔΙΩΝΖ ΕCΕΡΨΑΥ. ΤΕΝCΡΒΕ ΕΠΕΨΑΝΑ ΖΩΩΝ ΜΝΤΔΙΑΚΟΝΙΑ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ.

35. ΑΥCΩΠΤ ΝCΟΟΥ ΝΡΩΜΕ ΜΜΑΙ ΕΤΕΝΑΙΝΕ ΝΕΥΡΑΝ ΠΑΡ-ΜΕΝΑC ΑΥΩ ΝΙΚΟΛΑΟC ΜΝΠΡΟΧΟΡΟC ΑΥΩ ΦΙΛΙΠΠΟC ΜΝΔΙΜΩΝ ΑΥΩ ΝΙΚΑΝΩΡ. ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΤΗΡΟΥΝΕ ΖΕΝΡΕQΩΜΘΕΝΟΥΤΕ ΕΥΜΟΟ-ΨΕ ΖΝΟΥΤΕΒΟ ΕΥCΟΥΤΩΝ ΖΝΝΕΥΖΒΗΥΕ ΤΗΡΟΥ.

36. ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΑΝΓΟΥΡΩΜΕ ΝΡΕQΕΡΝΟΒΕ ΝΤΕΜΠΩΑ ΑΝ ΕΔΙΑ-ΚΟΝΕΙ ΖΝΝΚΑ ΝΤΕΠΝΟΥΤΕ. ΡΩΜΕ ΝΙΜ ΕΤΝΑΡΟΕΙC ΕΝΕΝΚΑ ΜΠΗΙ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΝCΕΔΙΗΚΕ⁴ ΜΜΟΟΥ ΚΑΛΩC ΝCΕΤΑΛΥ ΜΝΕΤ-ΨΑΛΤ ΝCΕΤΜΧΟ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΖΗΤΟΥ ΚΑΚΩC ΝCΕΤΜΤ ΜΝΕΑΡΧΩΝ ΜΠΡΟCΧΑΡΙC ΝCΕΤΜΖΕΠΛΑΛΥ ΝΖΗΤΟΥ ΑΛΛΑ ΝCΕΕΡΠΕΥΡΟΟΥQ

⁴ Sic. Read ΔΙΑΚΟΝΕΙ

34. The twelve *Apostles* called the seventy-two *Disciples*¹⁹ (and) said to us all together : « Choose seven men among you, lovers of instruction, not being proud, not being *slanders*, but being workers (and) *stewards*, that they may have chance²⁰ of all the *wants* and the *money* and all the *needs* of the *Church*, and may have care of the *widows* and *nourish* them in a fit manner²¹. We, ourselves, (shall) persevere unto the prayer and the ministry of God²² ».

35. They chose six men together with me, whose names are : Parmenas, and Nicolas (Nikolaos), and Prochoros, and Philip (Philippos), and Timon (Dimôn), and Nicanor (Nicanôr). And all these were ministers of God, walking in purity, and being upright in all their deeds.

36. And I, I am a sinful man (and) am not worthy to *minister* to the things of God. All men who shall watch over the things of the house of²⁴ God, shall *minister* them *well* (and) shall give them to those who are needy, (and) shall not spend them *ill* (and) shall not give (them) to the *chiefs* as (?) a *gratification*, (and) shall not hide anything of them, *but*

¹⁹ Cf. *Acts*, vi, 1-3.

²⁰ *Lit.* 'that they may be upon... ».

²¹ *Lit.* 'life'.

²² Cf. *Acts*, vi, 4.

²⁴ In a different order in *Acts*, vi, 5.

ΧΕΑΥΤΑΝΖΟΥΤΟΥ ΚΑΛΩC ΝCΕΤΑΛΥ ΜΝΕΤΨΑΛΤ ΜΝΝΕΤΕΡ-ΔΡΩΖ. ΤΖΟΜΟΛΟΓΕΙ ΝΗΤΝ ΧΕCΕΝΑΨΩΠΕ ΝΚΑΗΡΟΝΟΜΟC ΖΝΤ-ΜΝΤΡΡΟ ΝΝΗΠΗΥΕ.

37. ΕΨΩΠΕ ΝΤΟQ ΕCΦΑΝΨΩΠΕ ΝCΕΚΑΤΑΦΡΟΝΕΙ ΝΝΟΕΙΚ ΝΤΕΚΚΑΗCΙΑ ΜΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΑΥΩ ΝCΕΤΜΤ ΜΝΕΤΨΑΛΤ ΝΖΗΤΟΥ ΜΝΝΕΤΕΡΔΡΩΖ ΑΛΛΑ ΝCΕΟΥΟΜΟΥ ΝCΕCΟΟΥ ΑΥΩ ΝCΕΧΟΟΡΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΝΟΥCΠΑΤΑΛΑΛΙΑ ΤΕΝΖΟΜΟΛΟΓΕΙ ΝΗΤΝ ΑΝΟΝΠΕ ΠCΑΨQ ΝΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΟC ΧΕΝΘΕ ΝΤΑΥΧΩΠΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΝΕΝΚΑ ΝΤΕΚΚΑΗ-CΙΑ ΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΝΑΧΩΠΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΝΕΥΚΕΕC ΑΥΩ ΠΕΤΟΥΝΑΒΙΤQ ΝΖΗΤΟΥ ΝQΝΑΕΡΨΑΥ ΝΑΥ ΑΝ ΑΛΛΑ ΕΥΝΑΨΩΠΕ ΖΑΖΕΝΑΥΠΕΙ ΜΝΖΕΝΨΩΠΕ ΕΥΩQ ΝΤΕΝΕΥΚΕΕC CΡΟQΡΕQ ΖΝΟΥΔΕΠΗ ΧΕΝΕ-ΕΝΚΑΝΕ ΝΤΕΚΚΑΗCΙΑ ΑΥCΡΕΡΨΩΟΥ ΑΥΟΥΟΜΟΥ ΝΧΙΝΧΗ. ΕΨΧΕ ΠΝΟΥΤΕ ΝΑΚΡΙΝΕ ΜΝΕΠΤΡΟΠΟC ΜΝΝΕΤΖΙΧΝΝΕΑΡΧΩΝ ΧΕΑΥ-ΤΑΚΟ ΝΝΕΥΕΝΚΟ ΑΥΧΟΟΡΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΚΑΚΩC ΜΑΛΛΩΝ ΔΕ ΠΕΪΩΤ ΜΠΕΝΧΟΕΙC ΙC ΠΕΧC ΝΤΟQ ΠΕΤΝΑΚΡΙΝΕ ΜΠΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΟC ΧΕΑΥ-ΤΑΚΟ ΜΠΕΥΩΜΨΕ ΑΥΩ ΑΥΧΩΠΕ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΝΕΖΙCΕ ΜΠΕΝΧΟΕΙC ΙC ΠΕΧC ΠΑΟΓΟC ΜΠΕΪΩΤ ΚΑΤΑΘΕ ΝΤΑQΧΟΟC ΝQΠΑΥΛΟC ΠΑΠΟCΤΟΛΟC ΧΕΝΑΙ ΕΤΨΟΟΠ ΖΑΖΕΝΕΠΤΡΟΠΟC ΜΝΖΕΝΟΙ-ΚΟΝΟΜΟC ΨΑΤΕΠΡΟΘΕCΜΙΑ ΜΠΕΪΩΤ. ΤΑΙ ΖΩΩQΤΕ ΘΕ ΕΑΝ-

shall watch over them because they were *well* entrusted to them (and) they shall give them to those who are needy and to those who are in want. I *confess* to you that they shall be *heirs* in the Kingdom of the Heavens.

37. If, again, it happen that they *despise* the bread of the *Church* of God and do not give to those who are needy and who are in want among them *but* eat of them (the things) (and) drink of them (the things) and spend them in *wantonness*, we *confess* to you, we the seven *stewards*, that as they dispersed the things of the *Church*, God shall disperse their bones, and that which they shall take away from them, shall not profit them, *but* they shall be in *grief* and in much sickness (and) their bones shall wither speedily, because they are the things of the *Church* (and) they have dissipated them, (and) have devoured in vain. If God shall judge the *guardians* and those who are above the *chiefs*, because they have destroyed their things (and) have wasted them *ill*, *how much more* the Father of Our Lord Jesus Christ. He it is Who shall *judge* the *stewards*²⁵ because they destroyed their ministry and brought to nought the labours of Our Lord Jesus Christ, the Word of the Father, *even* as saith Paul the *Apostle* : « These who are under *guardians* and *stewards* unto the term appointed of the Father²⁶ ».

²⁵ MS. reads 'steward'.

²⁶ Cf. *Gal.*, iv, 2.

СПΟΥΔΑΣΕ ΕΑΡΙΣΚΕ ΜΠΧΟΕΙC ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΝΕΡΖΜΖΑΑ ΝΑQ
ΖΝΟΥΜΕ ΑΥΩ ΝΤΕΝΩΜΩΕ ΝΑQ ΖΝΟΥΔΙΚΑΙΟCΥΝΗ.

38. ΑΝΑΥ ΕΙΩCΗΦ ΝΤΕΡΕΠΕQΧΟΕΙC ΤΑΖΟQ ΕΡΑΤQ ΕΧΜΠΕQΗ
ΜΝΝΕΤΩΟΠ ΝΑQ ΤΗΡΟΥ. ΑΥΩ ΜΠΕΝCΩΤΗ ΖΕΝΕΓΡΑΦΗ ΧΕ-
ΑQΤΑΚΕΛΛΑΥ ΖΝΝΕΕΝΚΑ ΜΠΕQΧΟΕΙC ΜΑΛΙCΤΑ ΕΑΝCΩΤΗ
ΧΕΑΠΕCΜΟΥ ΩΠΠΕ ΖΜΠΗ ΜΠΡΜΝΚΗΜΕ ΕΤΒΕΙΩCΗΦ.

39. ΑΝΑΥ ΕΙΑΚΩΕ ΝΤΑΛΑΒΑΝ ΤΑΝΖΟΥΤQ ΕΠΕQΟΖΕ ΝΕCΟΟΥ
ΑΥΩ ΑQΕΡΜΝΤΡΕ ΝΑQ ΧΕΜΠΕΙΝΕ ΝΑΚ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΜΠΕΝΤΑΟΥΘΥ-
ΡΙΟΝ ΤΑΚΟQ ΑΥΩ ΜΠΙΤ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΟΥΖΙΕΙΒ ΖΝΝΕΚΟΖΕ ΝΕCΟΟΥ Η
ΟΥΜΑC ΝΒΟΟΜΠΕ ΝΧΙΟΥΕ. ΑΥΩ ΝQΕΡΜΝΤΡΕ ΟΝ ΧΕΑΝΟΚ
ΤΩΟΠ ΖΜΠΚΑΥΜΑ ΜΠΕΖΟΟΥ ΜΝΤΕΥΩΗ ΕQΖΜΠΧΑQ ΑΥΩ ΟΝ
ΑΠΖΙΝΗΕ CΑΖΩΩQ ΕΒΟΛ ΜΜΟΙ ΕΙΡΟΕΙC ΕΝΕΚΕCΟΟΥ ΝΤΕΥΩΗ.

40. ΑΝΑΥ ΕΜΩΥCΗC ΕQΡΟΕΙC ΕΝΑΠΑΡΧΗ ΜΝΝΡΕΜΗΤ ΝΤΑ-
ΝΕΩΗΡΕ ΜΠΗΛ ΤΑΑΥ ΝΑQ. ΑΝΟΝ ΔΕ ΖΩΩΝ ΜΑΡΕΝΔΙΗΚΕ⁵
ΝΕΝΚΑ ΝΙΜ ΝΩΑΥΤΑΑΥ ΜΠΕΧC ΝΑΩΡΟΝ ΕΝCΟΟΥΝ ΧΕΜΝΝCΑ-
ΝΑΥ ΝΙΜ ΕΝΠΗΤ ΕΖΡΑΙ ΕΝΕQΩΙΧ ΝQΤ ΜΠΟΥΑ ΠΟΥΑ ΚΑΤΑΝΕQ-
ΖΕΗΥΕ. ΕCΕΩΩΠΠΕ ΔΕ ΕΤΡΕΝΔΙΝΕ ΝΟΥΝΑ ΜΠΕQΕΜΤΟ ΕΒΟΛ
ΝΤΟQ ΠΕΝΧΟΕΙC ΙC ΠΕΧC ΠΑΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΙΤΟΟΤQ ΕΡΕΟΟΥ ΝΙΜ

⁵ Sic. Read ΔΙΑΚΟΝΕΙ.

And thus we have *hastened* to *please* the Lord and serve Him in truth and worship Him in *righteous*.

38. Behold Joseph, when his Lord set him over his house and all his belongings. We did not hear in the *Scriptures* that he destroyed anything of the things of his lord; *rather* we heard that blessing was in the house of the Egyptian on account of Joseph²⁷.

39. Behold Jacob to whom Laban entrusted his flock of sheep. And he bore witness to him saying : « I did not bring up unto thee that which a *wild beast* had destroyed, and I did not sell a sheep of thy flocks of sheep or a kid stealthily ». And he bore witness also, saying : « I was in the *heat* of the day and in the frost of the night and also sleep departed from me as I watched over thy sheep at night²⁸ ».

40. Behold Moses watching over the *first-fruits* and the tithes which the Children of Israël gave to him²⁹. And let us, ourselves *minister* in all things which they are wont to give to Christ as a *gift*, knowing that after every time we go unto His hands. He gives to every one *according* to his works. May it *now* be (given to us) to find mercy before Him, He, Our

²⁷ Cf. *Gen.*, xxxix, 5.

²⁸ Cf. *Gen.*, xxxi, 40.

²⁹ Cf. *Deut.*, xiv, 22.

ΠΡΕΠΕΙ ΝΑQ ΜΝΠΕQΕΙΩΤ ΝΑΓΑΦΟC ΜΝΠΕΠΝΑ ΕΤΟΥΑΒ
ΝΡΕQΤΑΝΖΟ ΑΥΩ ΝΖΟΜΟΟΥCΙΟΝ ΤΕΝΟΥ ΑΥΩ ΝΟΥΟΕΙΩ ΝΙΜ
ΩΑΝΑΙΩΝ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΝΝΕΩΝ ΖΑΜΗΝ.

Lord Jesus Christ through Whom is *due* unto Him with His *Good* Father and the Holy, Lifegiving and *Consubstantial Spirit* all glory now and at every time unto all ages of the ages Amen.

Cairo,
Coptic Museum.

YASSÄ 'ABD AL-MASIH.